

China Mobile announced 2026-27 optical cable tender

Quick Note

What happened?

China Mobile (CM) (941 HK, Buy) on 8 July released a tender announcement for the 2026-27 normal optical cable centralized procurement. The procurement of normal optical cable products is about 69.2mn fiber km (fkm), and the demand fulfillment period is 9 months after the issuance of the procurement results, which translates to an annual demand of about 92.3mn fkm. This annual demand volume decreases by 6.6% y-y, compared to 98.8mn fiber km for the 2025-26 procurement. CM did not announce the bidding price limit for this tender; however, based on the recent price hike in the fiber optic industry, we expect bidding prices to rise this year. In 2025, the weighted average bidding price was CNY53.85 per fkm (including VAT) for cable products (while the optical fiber price was <CNY25fkm). We expect the tender results to be announced within a month, alongside details about prices and share allocation to suppliers who have won the bid.

Nomura's view

We think optical fiber demand has gone through a meaningful shift from the telecom market to the AIDC market, which has led to a meaningful market spot price hike in the past 6 months. For CM's 2026-27 tender, we expect a meaningful price increase vs last year, but we think optical fiber players bidding for this tender would still offer a discount to CM, which is a large strategic customer. YOFC stock has been significantly sold off in the past two weeks (down almost 40% vs the HSI's flat performance), and we think if the short-term overhang is over, YOFC should offer trading opportunities. In the longer term, we still need to watch whether major optical preform players would remain disciplined and prevent an oversupply situation. We maintain our Buy rating on YOFC with a TP of HKD266, based on a 23.7x FY27F EPS of CNY9.75.

Rating Remains	Buy
Target price Remains	HKD 266.00
Closing price 8 July 2026	HKD 151.90

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Appendix A-1

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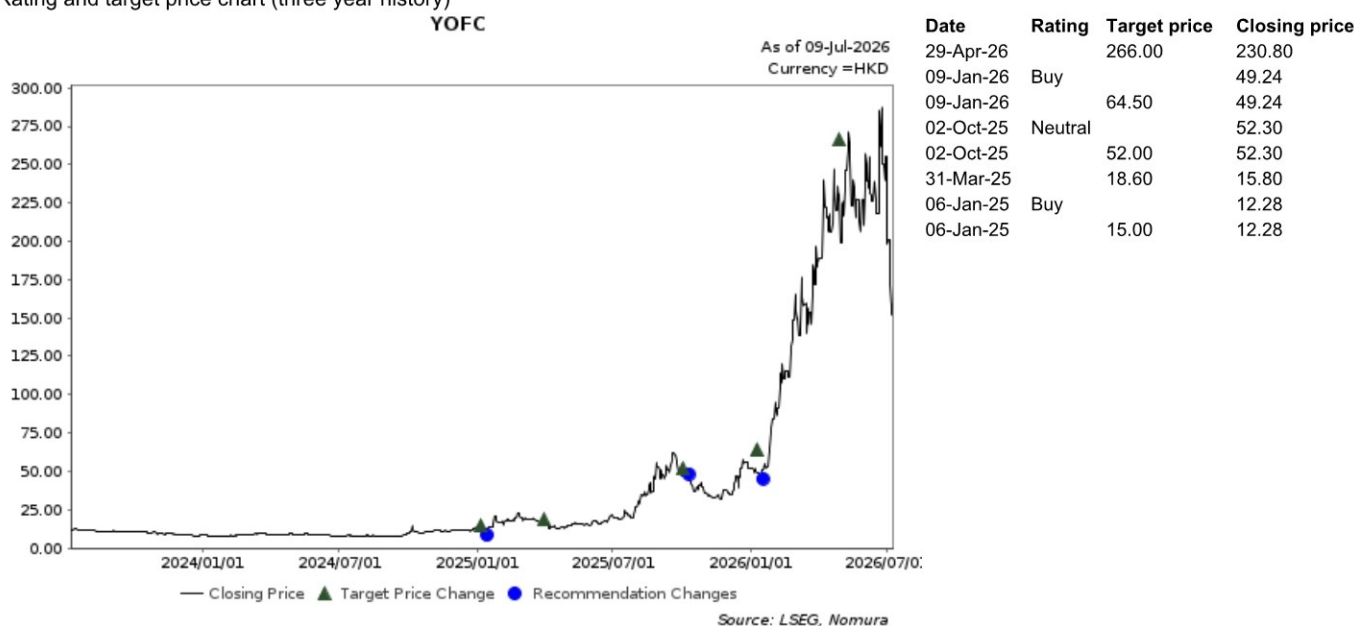
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
YOFC	6869 HK	HKD 151.90	08-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	

YOFC (6869 HK)

HKD 151.90 (08-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our TP of HKD266.00 is based on 23.7x FY27F EPS of CNY9.75, in line with WIND H-share cable companies' median P/E. The benchmark index for this stock is Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: 1) weaker-than-expected demand for optical fibres from China telecom operators; 2) weaker-than-expected AI networking business expansion, and; 3) lower-than-expected expansion of YOFC in overseas markets. Upside risks include: 1) faster-than-expected demand recovery from China telecom operators; 2) faster-than-expected penetration of high-end AI products, i.e. hollow-core fiber; 3) faster-than-expected expansion in overseas markets.

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As at 30 June 2026.

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